Petra Zlatarić-Novosel

Application: Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI
Quillstone Payments

Dear Hiring Team,

Your work on merchant questions, ticket routing and support-agent assistance connects directly with my experience in production NLP and customer complaint classification. As an ML Engineer at Slavonica Document AI, I develop and serve models for Croatian public administration documents. Previously, at Baranjska kreditna banka, I built complaint classifiers used for weekly customer service reporting. I would bring both experiences to Quillstone Payments' Customer Operations AI team.

At Slavonica, I fine-tuned XLM-R for 23 document classes, achieving 94% accuracy and macro F1 of 0.91, and served it through FastAPI and Docker on Azure App Service at approximately 15,000 documents per day. My work also covers production monitoring: a weekly drift report detected a silent OCR change at a client that reduced accuracy by 9 percentage points, and the issue was fixed within a week. This experience is directly relevant to your requirement to build, deploy and operate ML systems, rather than stop at a successful prototype.

Dataset quality and model evaluation are also central to my work. For Croatian named entity recognition, I built a 4,000-document annotated dataset with guidelines and two annotators, achieving inter-annotator kappa of 0.87, and fine-tuned BERTic. My toolkit includes Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, MLflow and Azure ML, supported by my Azure AI Engineer Associate certification. I have also explored retrieval-augmented question answering over Croatian laws in a personal prototype using sentence embeddings, FAISS and an open-weight LLM API; this was exploratory work, not a production assistant.

Quillstone's focus on helping merchants get support quickly offers a clear application for my background in extracting useful information from text. Your emphasis on service ownership also aligns with the deployment and monitoring work I have undertaken. I would welcome a conversation about how my production NLP experience and customer-service classification background could contribute to your team.

Kind regards,
Petra Zlatarić-Novosel